

MIAE 215 · Mini-Course Troubleshooting Guide

Concordia University · Department of Mechanical, Industrial & Aerospace Engineering (MIAE)

Source: [MECH 215 Mini Course Troubleshooting Guide](#)

Table of Contents

1. [Security Warning: "File can't be downloaded securely"](#)
 2. [Video Player & Audio Playback Diagnostics](#)
 3. [Operating System Compatibility & Windows 10/11](#)
 4. [Compiler Detection & The Infamous "Plus Button"](#)
 5. [Virtual Machines & Parallels UNC Path Errors](#)
 6. [Top IDE Runtime Traps & Solutions](#)
-

1. Security Warning: "File can't be downloaded securely"

When downloading `.exe`, `.rar`, or `.cpp` course materials from the Concordia university web servers via Google Chrome or Microsoft Edge, you may receive a browser security banner stating:

"File can't be downloaded securely"

Resolution:

1. Right-click the warning banner in your browser's download manager.
 2. Select **"Keep"** (or click the three dots . . . o **"Keep anyway"**).
 3. The university HTTP server is trusted; your browser flags it simply because the download link uses standard HTTP instead of HTTPS.
-

2. Video Player & Audio Playback Diagnostics

Some students experience missing sound when playing lecture recordings:

1. **Lesson #1 Has No Audio:** Prof. Gordon created the Lesson #1 installation screen captures without audio narration (except for `code1ite_mac_install_more.mp4`). Audio narration begins in **Lesson #2**.
 2. **Download First:** Do not attempt to stream high-bitrate video directly through browser tabs. Right-click the video link o select **"Save link as..."** o save to disk.
 3. **Recommended Video Player:** Use **VLC Media Player** (videolan.org). Standard Windows Media Player lacks certain MPEG-4 audio codecs. Alternate players: 5KPlayer (Mac/Win), KMPlayer (Win).
-

3. Operating System Compatibility & Windows 10/11

If you experience crashes when running legacy IDE installers on Windows:

- Upgrade your operating system to a modern 64-bit release of Windows 10 or Windows 11. Older versions (Windows 8/8.1) have buggy runtime compatibility layers for Mingw toolchains.
- If you cannot install software due to administrative privileges on a university laptop, use the **portable Code::Blocks package** located in: 05 - Software & Flowcharts/CodeBlocks_17.12_portable/codeblocks.exe

4. Compiler Detection & The Infamous "Plus Button"

If your IDE reports `No compiler detected` or `Can't find compiler executable in search path`:

1. In Code::Blocks, navigate to:
Settings ▾ Compiler... ▾ Selected Compiler: GNU GCC Compiler ▾ Toolchain Executables.
2. Verify that **Compiler's installation directory** points to the MinGW folder: `C:\Program Files\CodeBlocks\MinGW` (Or `CodeBlocks_17.12_portable\MinGW`).
3. Click **"Auto-detect"**.
4. In CodeLite on macOS, if the compiler is missing, install the Apple Command Line Developer Tools:

```
xcode-select --install
```

Then open CodeLite ▾ Settings ▾ Build Settings ▾ click the green **"+" (Plus) button** at time 5:12 in the demo video to auto-scan for `g++`.

5. Virtual Machines & Parallels UNC Path Errors

When running Windows inside **Parallels Desktop**, **VMware Fusion**, or **VirtualBox** on a Mac:

- **The Error:** `UNC paths are not supported. Defaulting to Windows directory.`
- **The Cause:** Mac network shared folders are exposed to Windows as UNC network shares (`\\mac\Home\Desktop`). The GCC compiler cannot compile directly on network shares.
- **The Fix:** Create your workspace and project folder directly on the virtual Windows `C:\` drive (e.g., `C:\miae215_projects\`). Never place projects on the Mac Desktop or shared iCloud folders when using a virtual machine.

6. Top IDE Runtime Traps & Solutions

Trap A: Console Closes Instantly

- **Cause:** Your program finished executing and the OS terminated the terminal window.
- **Solution:** Always place `getchar();` immediately before `return 0;` inside `main()`.

Trap B: "Target is up to date" (Old Output Still Displays)

- **Cause:** You clicked "Run" without clicking "Build" after modifying source code.
- **Solution:** Press **F9** (Build and Run) or click the yellow gear with green play icon.

Trap C: Antivirus False Positive

- **Cause:** Windows Defender or Avast may sandbox your freshly compiled `program.exe` because it has no commercial digital signature.
- **Solution:** Add an exclusion for your project directory in Windows Security.